Name: _____ Date: _____

DEALING WITH DISAPPOINTMENTS

Sometimes we have an idea in our mind about how something is supposed to happen. You might plan for the perfect birthday party at your house with all you friends there, or you might envision doing really well on a test because you studied. A disappointment is something doesn't go the way you planned or envisioned it to go. Everyone deals with disappointments sometimes, because they just happen in life. Not everything is going to go perfectly. So, it's important to learn how to deal with those disappointments.

#1 Express Your Feelings.

You might feel upset, annoyed, sad, or even angry over the disappointment. It's normal to feel what you're feeling. Find a healthy way to express your emotions. That might mean talking to someone, using an I statement, or writing your thoughts down.

#2 Gain Perspective.

Take some time to think about how big the problem really is. Sometimes it's easy to blow problems out of proportion when we are feeling upset. Stop and think, "Will this problem matter in a day? A week? A month? A year?" If it's not so big, take a deep breathe and let it go.

#3 Use Positive Self-Talk

Positive self-talk is the inner voice we have that reassures us. Tell yourself that everything will work out, things will improve, and that you can get through this. Remind yourself that you are strong and can accomplish anything you put your mind to.

#4 Consider Next Steps

Use the disappointment to teach you a lesson in how to move forward. If you didn't do well on a test, consider why. If you got in trouble at school, think about what you could have done differently. Use the experience to help you move forward.

#5 Don't Dwell

One of the biggest challenges of dealing with disappointments is getting stuck. Sometimes when you feel upset from a let down, it's hard to let it go. You might keep replaying the situation in your head over and over. This is called dwelling. Dwelling on a situation really isn't healthy, positive, or solution-focused at all. So, ditch the dwelling and move forward!

----- THINK ABOUT IT! -----

When was a time you were disappointed? How might you handle it now?

Name: _____ Date: _____

DISAPPOINTMENTS HELP US GROW

Believe it or not, disappointments and let downs can actually help us learn and grow. Here are just a few things that a let down can teach you.

#1 What's Really Important.

If you feel let down, you know that something really matters to you. Use that to drive you in the future. For example, if you feel disappointed about not doing well on a test, that's a good thing! You recognize that your grades and performance in that class matter. Use this fact to stay motivated and encourage yourself in the future.

#2 Ways to Improve.

Take a clear look at what happened and consider if there are ways you can improve for next time. Sometimes with let downs, this isn't the case, and that's okay. Other times, though, you can learn ways to make an improvement for the situation in the future. For example, if you're feeling disappointed in the way you gave your oral presentation, ask yourself to come up with three ways you could improve for next time.

#3 How to Persevere.

Without a doubt, disappointments make us stronger! All successful people had disappointments happen in their lives. Michael Jordan was cut from his high school basketball team and Oprah Winfrey was told she'd never make it as a talk show host. Both of those people (and many others) worked through their challenges and let downs to become successful. You can, too.

----- THINK ABOUT IT! -----

Imagine that a friend is dealing with a disappointment. What advice might you give them to help them through it?

